

Modelling is necessary because an object needs to move, rotate, or scale, based on the restrictions and properties assigned to another object. The third Linking tool in the section is the Bind to Space Warp tool. It is used to attach objects and space warps together. Then comes the selection tools that let you select objects by clicking on them or by selecting them by name. The Selection filter lets you to limit what can be selected with the cursor. You can also choose to specify the method for selecting objects by using a selection window, which lets you indicate a selection by placing a rectangle, circle, or other border around the objects.

To the right of the Selection tools are the Transform tools. This set of tools lets you move, rotate, and scale objects. You can also choose the reference coordinate system, set the centre of the transform using the pivot options, toggle keyboard shortcut overrides, use different snap options, work with named selection sets, and use tools to mirror and align objects. The next group of tools to the right includes access to the Layer Manager, Graphite Modeling tools, the Track View Curve Editor, Schematic View tools, and the Materials and Rendering tools.

The Layer Manager gives you control over all the settings for layers in your scene and the objects contained in those layers. The Graphite Modeling tools are a completely new set of over 100 tools to improve creating and editing poly objects within 3ds Max. The Curve Editor tools display your scene information as graphs or wiring diagrams to indicate the functionality or relationships of scene objects. The Schematic View tools provide a visual graph and control how all the elements of your scene are linked. The Materials tools give you control over the appearance of objects by defining and applying their surface properties. With these tools, you can create color, texture, opacity, and other material characteristics, and then apply these characteristics to objects in your model. You can also open the Render Setup dialog box, select the render type, and perform a quick render with the buttons on the far right.

The Rendering tools give you control over the image output of your 3ds Max scene. Unlike output from most applications, output from 3ds Max Design 2010 is most likely to be image or animation files, or real-time virtual models. The Rendering tools let you set the type and size of output, from single, large-format stills to video-ready animations.

1.1.6 Working on a Lower-Resolution System

In case you are working on a screen with a screen resolution less than 1280x1024, you probably will not be able to see all the different tools in the main toolbar. Some of the tools just become unavailable after the right end of